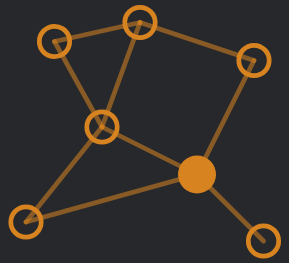
ISAC Yearly Seminar · Shenkar

Who Gets to Submit?

Designing credit systems for peer review

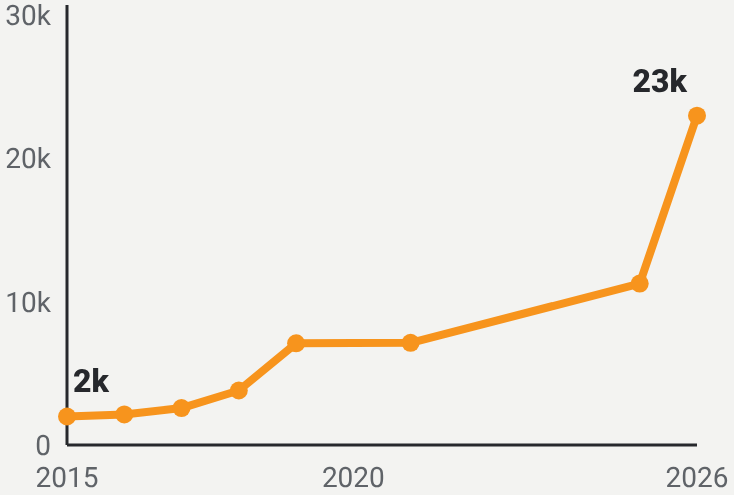


Nimrod Talmon · with Ariel Rosenfeld, Peter Stone and Staša Milojević

Ben-Gurion University of the Negev · November 2026

Writing got cheap; reviewing, much less

AAAI papers reviewed per year



official counts only; some years missing

1. AI helps: at AAAI-26, each paper got an AI review
2. Still, we want human gatekeepers
3. Overload makes reviews noisier

Venues already ration submissions



Caps

at most N papers

IJCAI: 8 · AAAI: 10



Embargoes

rejected? wait

ERC · PVLDB: 1 year



Review to submit

submit, then review

AAMAS · ICML · IJCAI



Fees

pay per paper

IJCAI: $100 a paper

Venues already ration submissions

All of these are credit systems



Caps

at most N papers

IJCAI: 8 · AAAI: 10



Embargoes

rejected? wait

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Review to submit

submit, then review

AAMAS · ICML · IJCAI



Fees

pay per paper

IJCAI: $100 a paper

So let's design one properly

The goal

Accept as many good papers as possible, and as few bad ones



many good

few bad

Fair to authors

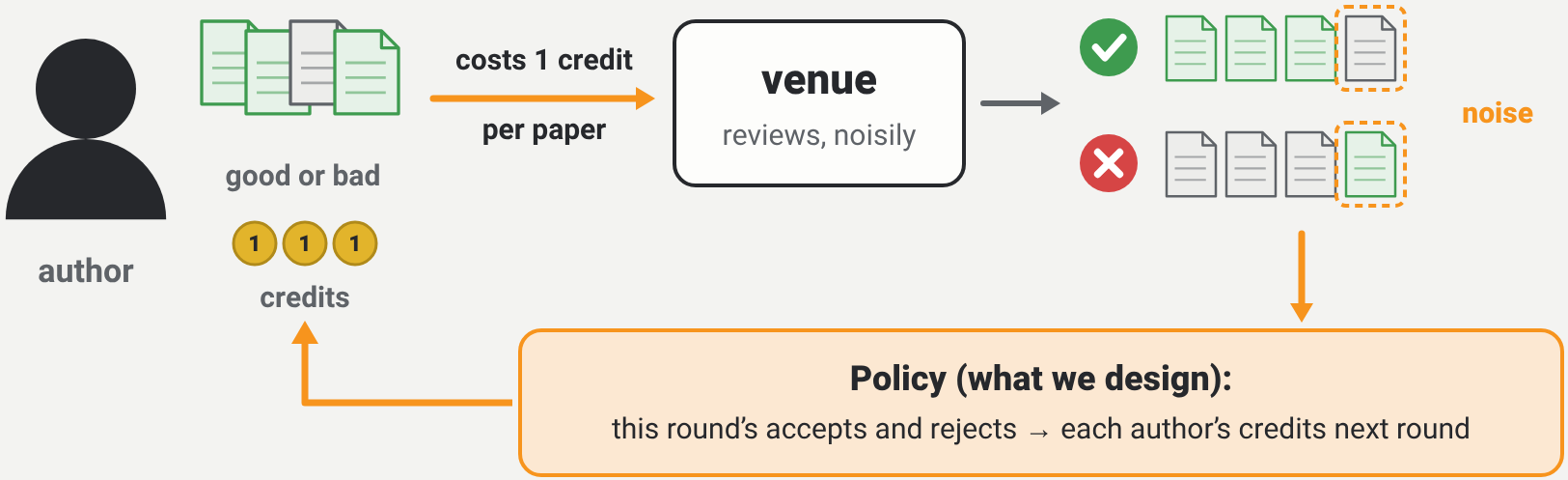
1. More good papers, more credits
2. Always at least one credit
3. Slow periods are free

The simplest setting

Paper: “Who Gets to Submit?” · with Rosenfeld, Stone and Milojević · NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on AI-Native Academia

One venue · one author per paper

Each author can write some good papers per round, and any number of bad ones

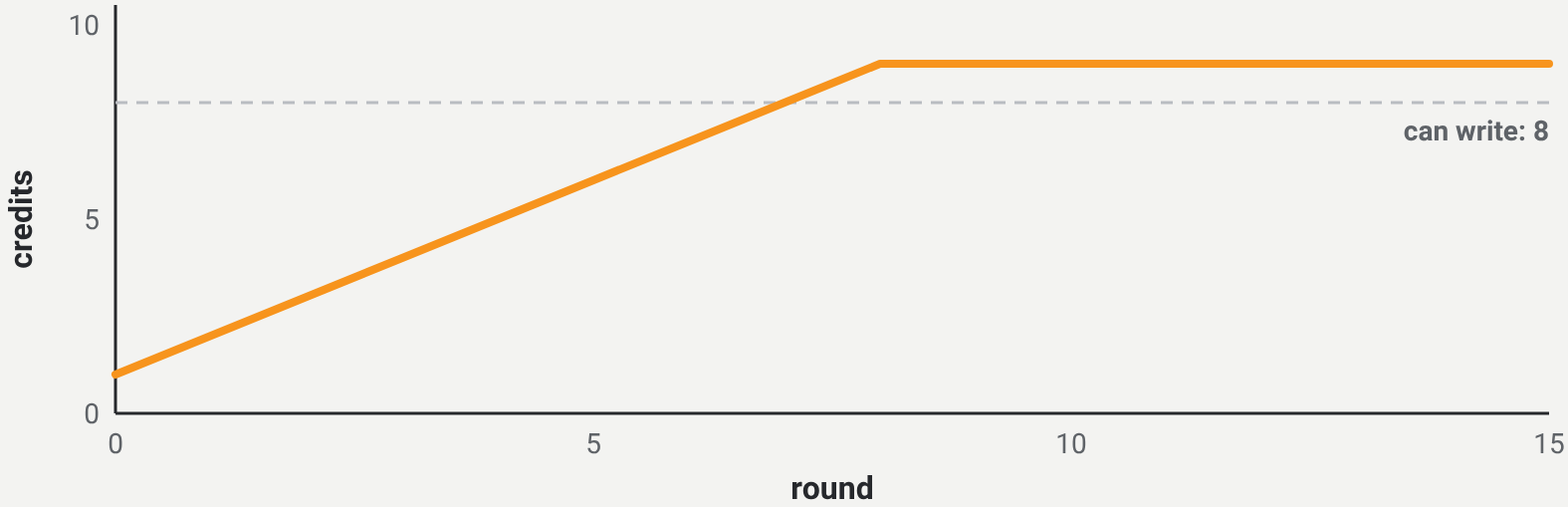


If we assume no noise, then a solution exists

The perfect-round bonus

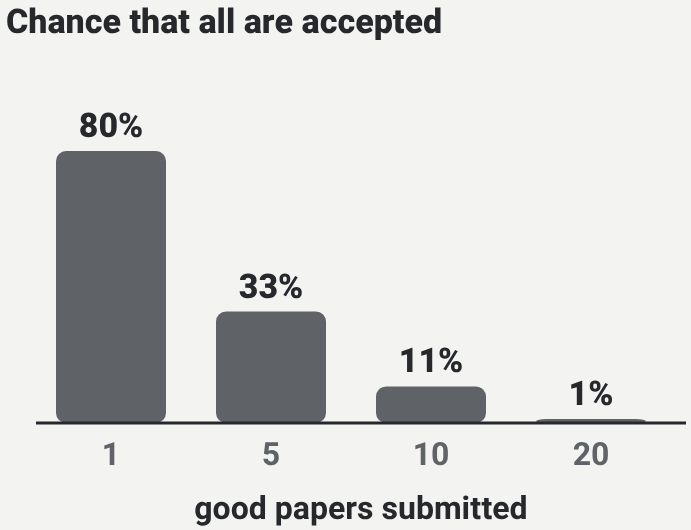
If we assume no noise, then a solution exists

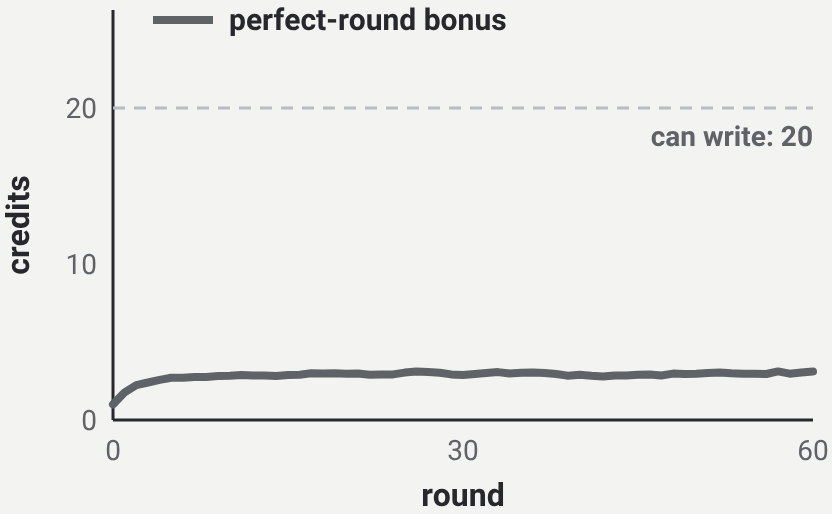
Each accepted paper returns its credit; if all are accepted, then +1 bonus



But with noise, it breaks

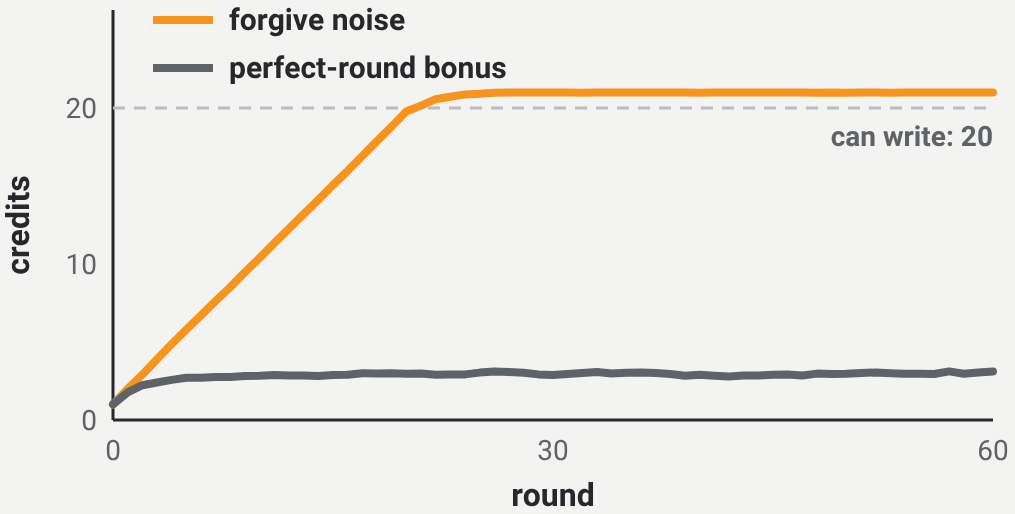
Reviewers err, say, 1 time in 5: the more you send, the rarer a perfect round





The fix: forgive what noise explains

Only rejections beyond what noise plausibly causes cost a credit



- **More good papers, more credits**
- **Always at least one**
- **Slow periods: almost free**

Where this goes

From one venue and one author per paper, toward the real system

Data-based modeling

Fit authors, noise and load to real submission records

Model relaxations

Several authors per paper, several venues, credits for reviewing

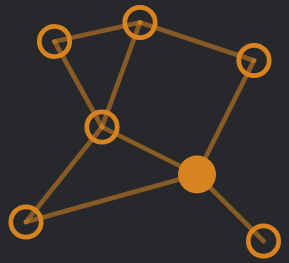
More settings

Pull requests, bug bounties, app stores

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